openScope: how to play and every command

You are the approach and departure controller. Aircraft appear on the radar and as strips on the right. You give them instructions; they read them back and fly them.

Play in two minutes

1. **Start:** `npm run build` then `npm run start`, open `http://localhost:3003`. Pick an airport with the airport button (search by city, IATA code or country). Press **F8** any time for the in-game controls guide.
2. **Select an aircraft:** click it or its strip, or use PageUp / PageDown. The side panel shows squawk, route, QNH, fuel and souls on board. The command bar fills in its callsign.
3. **Departures:** the pilot asks for the IFR clearance at the stand. Answer with `caf` (cleared as filed; the pilot reads back SID, runway, climb and squawk), `push`, `taxi 27R` (it follows the taxiways, see the ground chart on **F9**), optionally `lineup`, then `cto`. Nothing departs without your clearance. Then vector, climb and route direct.
4. **Arrivals:** `dvs` or altitude and speed steps (`d 80`, `sp 210`), `e 27R` (expect runway), vector onto the centreline, `i 27R` (cleared ILS). Keep them separated and landing; a go-around is `ga`.
5. **Type or talk: F4** opens the radio. Type a sentence ("Speedbird one two three, descend flight level eight zero") or hold **Right Shift** and speak. With a Claude key it understands anything you say; without one it understands standard phraseology.
6. **Watch for trouble:** low fuel, MAYDAY (squawk 7700), radio failure (7600), medical and technical problems. Ask `sf` for fuel, send them `divert EGCC`, answer requests with `roger` or `unable`. Frequency is set in Settings (Failures and emergencies).
7. **Keep the ATIS current** (F3). Pilots quote the information letter they last heard.

Keys and mouse

Click aircraft / PageUp, PageDown, up, down	Select an aircraft (up/down also select unless Settings > Control Method = Arrow Keys)
Tab	Search and autocomplete commands
Esc	Close dialogs, then deselect
F1 / F2	Shorten / lengthen the predicted track line
F3	ATIS: update, edit, read aloud, AI-suggested remarks
F4	Radio panel: type or speak to pilots
Right Shift (hold)	Push to talk, from anywhere
F6	SIDs and STARs: list, highlight on the radar, assign to the selected aircraft
F9	Ground chart (taxiways, stands, holding points); it also appears when you zoom in on the airfield
F8	Controls guide
Numpad / * + -	Insert takeoff, ILS, speed up, speed down
Arrow keys (Control Method = Arrow Keys)	left / right insert a turn, up / down insert climb / descend
` (backquote)	Switch between aircraft commands and scope commands
Mouse wheel / drag	Zoom / pan the scope

Hundreds of feet: `d 30` = descend to 3,000 ft; above the transition altitude the same number is a flight level (`c 120` = FL120). Headings are three digits (`090`); one or two digits after a direction mean degrees to turn (`t l 20` = turn left 20 degrees). Runways are written like `27R` or `09L`. Commands can be chained: `BAW123 t l 270 d 40 sp 210`.

Aircraft commands

Every command starts with the aircraft: `AAL123 <command>`. Several commands can follow one callsign. Shorter aliases are shown first.

Departures

Used by aircraft on the ground, in this order. The pilot calls for the clearance, then for push and taxi.

Command	Type	What it does
Cleared as filed	`AAL123 caf`	IFR clearance on the filed plan and SID. The pilot reads back destination, SID, runway, initial climb and squawk.
SID	`AAL123 sid [name]`	Clear them via a different SID (same readback).
Pushback	`AAL123 push`	Pushback and start-up approved (alias pb). Needs the clearance first. Optional: taxi also pushes back.
Taxi / hold short	`AAL123 taxi [runway] [via A B]`	Taxi along the taxiways to the holding point; larger airports take longer. via names taxiways to prefer. Aliases: w, wait.
Hold position	`AAL123 hp`	Stop where they are. taxi sets them off again.
Line up and wait	`AAL123 lineup`	Onto the runway, visible on the radar, and wait (alias lu). Optional.
Climb via SID	`AAL123 cvs | cvs [alt]`	Climb following the SID restrictions, optionally to an altitude.
Takeoff	`AAL123 cto`	Cleared for takeoff (numpad /). Aliases: to, takeoff. Refused without an IFR clearance.

Arrivals

Used by aircraft inbound to the airport.

Command	Type	What it does
Expect runway	`AAL123 e [runway]`	Tell them which runway to plan for (also selects the right STAR branch).
Descend via STAR	`AAL123 dvs | dvs [alt]`	Descend following the STAR restrictions, optionally to an altitude.
ILS approach	`AAL123 i [runway]`	Cleared ILS (numpad *). Aliases: ils, *. They intercept the localizer and glideslope, land and leave frequency.
Go around	`AAL123 ga`	Break off the approach: climb on runway heading to a safe altitude and wait. Aliases: goaround, missed.
Divert	`AAL123 divert [ICAO]`	Divert to any airport in the airport index. The pilot checks fuel and runway length first. Alias: dvt.

Heading, altitude, speed

The basic instructions.

Command	Type	What it does
Heading (turn)	`AAL123 t l|r [hdg] | fh [hdg]`	Turn left/right to a heading; fh takes the short way. Aliases: h, heading, turn, t.
Turn by degrees	`AAL123 t l|r [deg]`	One or two digits means degrees to turn, not a heading: t r 20.
Fly present heading	`AAL123 fph`	Cancel a turn. Before takeoff: fly runway heading.
Altitude	`AAL123 c|d [alt] | c [alt] ex`	Climb or descend (hundreds of ft; add ex to expedite). Aliases: a, altitude, climb, descend.
Speed	`AAL123 sp [kt] | + [kt] | - [kt]`	Assign a speed in knots. Aliases: speed, slow. They refuse (unable) outside their envelope.

Routing

Change where an aircraft is going.

Command	Type	What it does
Proceed direct	`AAL123 pd [fix]`	Fly direct to a fix. Aliases: dct, direct.
Hold	`AAL123 hold [fix] [l|r] [n]min|[n]nm [radial]`	Hold at a fix, e.g. hold DET l 2min.
Exit hold	`AAL123 xh | xh [fix]`	Leave the holding pattern (immediately, or at a fix). Aliases: continue, exithold, cancelhold, nohold.
Route	`AAL123 route [route]`	Insert a route that rejoins the current one, e.g. route FESKO..RUFUS..CHOIR (shortcuts, extensions). Single dots join procedures and airways, double dots fix to fix.
Reroute	`AAL123 rr [route]`	Replace the whole route. Alias: reroute.
STAR	`AAL123 star [transition].[name].[ICAO]`	Change the arrival procedure.
Cross	`AAL123 x [fix] a[alt] s[kt]`	Cross a fix at an altitude and/or speed. Aliases: cross, cr.

Questions to the pilot

The pilot answers with exact figures from the simulation.

Command	Type	What it does
Say fuel	`AAL123 sf`	Endurance and quantity; says if minimum fuel or fuel emergency. Alias: fuel.
Say persons on board	`AAL123 sob`	Souls on board. Aliases: souls, pob.
Say intentions	`AAL123 sint`	Repeats what the pilot has asked for. Alias: intentions.
Say information	`AAL123 sinfo`	The ATIS letter they hold. Alias: atisletter.
Say altitude / assigned	`AAL123 sa | saa`	Current altitude / altitude you assigned.
Say heading / assigned	`AAL123 sh | sah`	Current heading / heading you assigned.
Say speed / assigned	`AAL123 si | sas`	Indicated airspeed / speed you assigned.

Miscellaneous

Command	Type	What it does
Squawk	`AAL123 sq [code]`	Set the transponder code, e.g. sq 4521. Emergencies squawk 7700 (7600 radio failure).
Roger	`AAL123 roger`	Acknowledge a call or request. Does not grant it: give the instruction (e.g. pd FIX). Alias: rgr.
Unable	`AAL123 unable`	Turn a request down; the pilot carries on as planned. Alias: deny.

System commands

Typed without a callsign.

Command	Type	What it does
Airport	`airport [ICAO]`	Switch to another airport, e.g. airport EGGP.
Pause	`pause`	Pause the simulation; click to resume.
Timewarp	`tw [rate] | timewarp [rate]`	Speed up time (1 = normal; any value of 1 or more).
Tutorial	`tutorial`	Open the tutorial.

Scope commands (backquote to switch)

Affect the radar display, not aircraft.

Command	Type	What it does
Move data block	`[dir] [callsign] | [dir]/[len] [callsign]`	Dir is a numpad position (8 up, 2 down, 5 centred); len 0-6 is the leader line length.
Scratchpad	`[text] [callsign]`	Write 2-3 characters in an aircraft's data block; a full stop resets it.
Toggle halo	`QP_J [callsign] | QP_J [nm] [callsign]`	Show or hide a halo (default 3 nm) around an aircraft. F7 inserts QP_J.

Ask the application, in plain words

"open the ATIS" / "give me the latest information" / "update the ATIS"	Open, refresh or read the ATIS
"what is the wind" / "what is the QNH" / "which runway is in use"	Answers from the live weather and ATIS
"hide the SIDs" / "show the stars" / "show the airspace"	Radar layers
"open the ground chart" / "open the procedures list" / "open settings"	Screens
"make it quieter" / "busy" / "rush hour" / "more traffic"	Traffic level (also in Settings)
"switch to Manchester" / "zoom in" / "pause" / "speed up time"	Airport, view and clock

Type these in the command bar or the radio panel, or say them. Speech is cleaned up before it is interpreted: "the center flight level zero five zero" becomes "descend flight level 050", and callsigns and fixes that exist right now are matched to what the recogniser heard.

Talk to the pilots (F4)

"Speedbird one two three, turn left heading two seven zero"	`BAW123 t l 270`
"Easy six four alpha, descend flight level eight zero, reduce speed two one zero"	`EZY64A d 80 sp 210`
"Ryanair seven eight bravo, cleared ILS runway two seven right"	`RYR78B i 27R`
"Shamrock four two one, say fuel remaining" (or: how much fuel do you have)	`EIN421 sf`
"Speedbird one two three, go around"	`BAW123 ga`
"Speedbird one two three, divert to Manchester"	`BAW123 divert EGCC`
"Speedbird one two three, taxi to holding point runway two seven right via alpha bravo"	`BAW123 taxi 27R via A B`
"Speedbird one two three, line up and wait" / "cleared for take-off" / "hold position"	`BAW123 lineup / cto / hp`

Say the callsign first (airline name and number, or select the aircraft). Numbers are spoken digit by digit ("two seven zero", "niner"). Any sentence typed in the command bar that is not a command goes to the radio. For free-form speech and pilot voices add `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY` and `ELEVENLABS_API_KEY` to a `.env` file, or paste them in the AI & Voice dialog (the cog in the radio panel). Turn on the speaker button in the footer to hear the pilots.